

WHAT IS ECOTOURISM?

Key Words and Phrases • LEVEL B

The words and phrases below appear in the article *What Is Ecotourism?*. Study the table carefully, then complete the gap-fill exercise in Part 2.

PART 1 – VOCABULARY TABLE

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
sustainable	done in a way that can continue without causing lasting damage to the environment	<i>Sustainable ecotourism aims to protect natural areas for future generations.</i>
impoverished communities	communities that lack money, resources, and opportunities	<i>Ecotourism has helped provide economic growth in some of the world's most impoverished communities.</i>
conservation	the protection of the natural environment and its plants and animals	<i>Conservation is the most important principle of ecotourism — it must come before profit.</i>
biodiversity	the variety of plant and animal life in a particular environment	<i>The Galapagos Islands are celebrated for their extraordinary biodiversity.</i>
alleviation	the reduction of pain, difficulty, or a serious problem	<i>Ecotourism can contribute to the alleviation of poverty in rural communities.</i>
greenwashing	making misleading claims about environmental responsibility to attract customers	<i>Some travel companies engage in greenwashing — presenting ordinary holidays as eco-friendly.</i>
ecological footprints	the total impact a person or activity has on the natural environment	<i>Ecotourism educates visitors about ways to reduce their own ecological footprints.</i>
interact	to communicate or come into contact with someone or something	<i>When tourists interact with wild animals, there is always a risk of unintended harm.</i>
overlooked	not noticed or given enough attention	<i>Education is one of the most overlooked but important aspects of ecotourism.</i>
vibrant	full of life, energy, and colour	<i>Costa Rica's vibrant wildlife attracts over 1.7 million ecotourists every year.</i>
sanctuaries	places set aside to protect animals, nature, or people from harm	<i>Wildlife sanctuaries in New Zealand protect rare and endangered native species.</i>
ecotourism	responsible travel to natural areas that supports conservation and local communities	<i>Tanzania earns over \$1 billion a year from ecotourism, supporting 400,000 jobs.</i>
livelihood	the way a person earns money and supports themselves and their family	<i>Ecotourism provides an alternative livelihood for communities that might otherwise rely on poaching.</i>

WORD / PHRASE	DEFINITION	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
poaching	the illegal hunting or capturing of wild animals	<i>Sustainable ecotourism income reduces the incentive for local people to engage in poaching.</i>
indigenous	originating from and naturally belonging to a particular place or culture	<i>The expansion of tourism has sometimes displaced indigenous communities from their traditional lands.</i>
viable	capable of working successfully; practical and able to produce results	<i>The IUCN cautions that not every ecotourism business model will be economically viable.</i>
empower	to give someone the authority, confidence, or means to do something	<i>Ecotourism should empower local communities rather than simply extracting profit from them.</i>

PART 2 – GAP-FILL EXERCISE

Complete the sentences using the correct word or phrase from the word bank below. You may need to change the form of the word. Some sentences require more than one answer.

WORD BANK

sustainable	impoverished communities	conservation	biodiversity
alleviation	greenwashing	ecological footprints	interact
overlooked	vibrant	sanctuaries	ecotourism
livelihood	poaching	indigenous	viable
empower			

1	_____ is responsible travel to natural areas that supports _____ and helps to _____ local communities economically.
2	It has helped provide growth in some of the world's most _____ communities by offering an alternative _____ to poaching and other unsustainable practices.
3	The three core principles are _____ of the environment, support for the community, and education to help tourists reduce their _____.
4	Protecting _____ is one of ecotourism's most important goals — destinations like the Galapagos and Costa Rica are celebrated for their remarkable variety of life.
5	Ecotourism can support poverty _____ — communities near protected areas in Costa Rica had poverty rates 16% lower than those in unprotected areas.
6	As the industry grows, so does the risk of _____ — where companies make misleading environmental claims simply to attract customers.

7	When tourists _____ with wild animals or natural environments, they risk altering animal behaviour in ways that make them more _____ to predators or _____.
8	One of the most _____ aspects of ecotourism is its educational role — teaching visitors about environmental issues and how they can live more _____.
9	New Zealand's _____ wildlife and diverse landscapes attract many visitors, and its national _____ protect some of the country's most fragile ecosystems.
10	The IUCN warns that not every ecotourism business will be _____ in the wider market, and that some areas are simply not appropriate for development.
11	In some cases, tourism expansion has displaced _____ communities from their traditional lands, preventing them from sharing in the economic benefits.

Write your answers here:

1. _____	2. _____	3. _____
4. _____	5. _____	6. _____
7. _____	8. _____	9. _____
10. _____	11. _____	